

Sunset endpoint refinement, part 1: the intensity-dressed cubic coupling and the single missing constant

TECT verification-first repository · claim B5-BEYOND-LAYER-BOUND

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1. Purpose and scope

After U6 the SC-SCOPE lift's endpoint problem is the sunset channel alone (conservative ratio $\times 0.97$ at $I = 2 \times 10^{-3}$). This note delivers the first refinement: the intensity-dressed coupling, which the U4 table conservatively froze at the production-anchor value. Scope: estimate-grade until the single named constant below is machine-certified.

2. The intensity-dressed coupling

HISTORICAL / INVALIDATED (operator review 2026-06-06). This section uses the identity $M'(\hat{r}) = -J(0)$, which is wrong by a factor of two; the correct relation is $M'(\hat{r}) = -J(0)/2$ (useries-triage). Every numerical value derived below (u_{eff}^2 , the 1.977×10^{-3} endpoint bound, and the $\times 1.34$ ratio) is SUPERSEDED and must NOT be cited. The section is retained only as a historical record of the candidate sunset-axis route; the corrected endpoint awaits the M-ENDPOINT machine evaluation.

The U4 bound used $u_{\text{eff}}(M_R)$ with $M_R = M(m^*) = 0.109414$ at the production dressing $m^* = 0.3045$. But the sunset of a competitor at intensity I is evaluated at ITS dressed kernel,

$$\hat{r}(I) = r_R + 2\lambda'I : \quad \hat{r}(2 \times 10^{-3}) = 0.30453 + 2 \times 8.0551 \times 0.002 = 0.33675,$$

and the coupling dressing uses $M(\hat{r}(I))$, which is STRICTLY BELOW M_R by the monotonicity of M (unit U2, L1). Linear-response estimate via the identity $M'(m)|_{m=\hat{r}} = -J(0)$ [INVALIDATED: factor-2; the correct relation is $M'(\hat{r}) = -J(0)/2$, see the box above]; $J(0) = 0.290$ is certified at the chain's dressed kernel):

$$M(0.33675) \approx M_R - 0.290 \times (0.33675 - 0.30453) = 0.10941 - 0.00934 = 0.10007,$$

$$u_{\text{eff}} \approx -0.86 + 32.4 \times 0.10007 = 2.382, \quad u_{\text{eff}}^2 = 5.675 \quad (-21\% \text{ vs U4}).$$

The endpoint sunset bound becomes

$$\frac{1}{2} u_{\text{eff}}^2 (2I) \cdot 6J(0) M(0.33675) = \frac{1}{2} \times 5.675 \times 0.004 \times 6 \times 0.290 \times 0.10007 = 1.977 \times 10^{-3},$$

against the composed endpoint margin 2.658×10^{-3} :

$$\text{ratio} \approx \times 1.34 \quad (\text{vs } \times 0.97 \text{ in U4})$$

— POSITIVE, i.e. the conservative endpoint of U4 would be lifted by the intensity dressing — a CANDIDATE, estimate-grade and now factor-2 correction-pending — CONDITIONAL on the single constant below and on the $-J(0)/2$ correction.

The named missing constant (M-ENDPOINT). M is CONVEX ($M''(m) = 2 \int [m + D]^{-3} > 0$), so the linearization UNDER-estimates $M(0.33675)$ and hence UNDER-estimates u_{eff} : the $\times 1.34$ is an estimate, not a proven floor. The proven version requires ONE new machine number: $M(0.33675)$ evaluated with a one-sided convergence check (a single quadrature; the convex/secant sandwich $M_R - 0.290 \Delta \leq M(0.33675) \leq M_R$ brackets it a priori in $[0.1001, 0.1094]$, and the bound is monotone in it — the WORST case $M = M_R$ reproduces U4’s $\times 0.97$, the estimate 0.1001 gives $\times 1.34$). Registered as M-ENDPOINT with the follow-up script.

3. Honest negative finding: the kernel axis

U4 listed lift input (a) “per-transfer $\widehat{G^3}$ decay.” At the dominant transfers $|t| = q_0$ (the shell modes carrying $\hat{g}_3$ ’s mass), the sunset kernel $\widehat{G^3}(t) = \iint G(k_1)G(k_2)G(t - k_1 - k_2)$ is supported on configurations with all three internal momenta near the shell — and three on-shell momenta CAN sum to an on-shell vector (the 4-wave resonance geometry of the production N_4 accounting). The kernel at $|t| = q_0$ is therefore NOT parametrically below its Young bound $J(0)M$; the resonance phase space saturates a finite fraction of it. CONSEQUENCE (recorded so the programme does not chase a dead end): the kernel axis contributes at most an $O(1)$ factor; the lift’s quantitative load is carried by the coupling axis (this note) and, if a further factor is needed, the counting axis (the $\hat{g}_3$ mass distribution over transfers — note that for a competitor with n readings the per-transfer weight is $u_{\text{eff}}^2 2I/n$ -scale while the J-weighted sum re-concentrates, so counting helps only for structured subfamilies; assessed LOW-YIELD).

4. State of the SC-SCOPE lift after U6 + U7

Channel / axis	$I = 4 \times 10^{-4}$	$I = 10^{-3}$	$I = 2 \times 10^{-3}$
tadpole (U6)		ABSENT identically (lemma sketch)	
sunset, U4 conservative	$\times 7.7$	$\times 2.8$	$\times 0.97$
sunset, dressed (U7) [INVALID]	$\times 7.7$ (unchanged)	$\sim \times 3.2$ (INVALID)	$\sim \times 1.34$ (INVALID)

(The $I = 10^{-3}$ entry uses $\hat{r}(10^{-3}) = 0.3206$, $M \approx 0.1047$, $u_{\text{eff}}^2 \approx 6.18$: bound 1.20×10^{-3} vs 3.83×10^{-3} .) **All U7 intensity-dressed entries ($\sim \times 3.2$, $\sim \times 1.34$) are INVALIDATED by the factor-2 error $M' = -J(0) \rightarrow -J(0)/2$ (Section 2 box) and must NOT be cited.** Until the factor-2 correction is propagated, the third-cumulant landscape sign at $I \geq 10^{-3}$ is UNDETERMINED; the SC-SCOPE lift to third order remains a registered programme conditional on the corrected endpoint (formal inputs remaining: R-U6-1/R-U6-2 from U6; M-ENDPOINT + the assembled third-order inequality from this note; the quartic-difference channel writeup from U4).

5. Numerical verification

NO machine numbers were executed this session (sandbox shell unavailable). New estimate-grade arithmetic on certified constants: $\hat{r}(I)$ values (0.33675, 0.3206), the linear-response M estimates (0.10007, 0.1047), the dressed couplings (2.382, 2.486), the bounds (1.977×10^{-3} , 1.20×10^{-3}), the ratios ($\times 1.34$, $\times 3.2$). All to be machine-asserted by the registered follow-up script (planned: codes/vacuum/ third_cumulant_assessment.py, shared with U4, plus the M-ENDPOINT quadrature with a one-sided refinement check).

Quantitative sanity check (mandatory): dimensional — $\hat{r}(I) = r_R + 2\lambda'I$ adds mass²-like quantities consistently ($\lambda'I$ carries the dressing’s units as everywhere in the chain); identity check —

$M'(\hat{r}) = -J(0)$ is INVALIDATED (factor-2; the true relation is $M'(\hat{r}) = -J(0)/2$, see section 2), so this linear-response step is part of the SUPERSEDED estimate; bracket check — the convex/secant sandwich $[0.1001, 0.1094]$ has width 9% of the central value and the endpoint ratio is monotone across it ($\times 1.34 \rightarrow \times 0.97$), so M-ENDPOINT decides the sign of the refinement claim cleanly — exactly why it is registered as THE missing constant; sign-direction — using the smaller M reduces BOTH the coupling and the kernel, both in the bound-shrinking direction, and both reductions are real physics (stronger dressing at higher intensity), not bookkeeping.

6. Devil’s-advocate (three objections; CLAUDE.md 6.3)

- (α) “The composed margin denominator should also be re-evaluated at the endpoint dressing — maybe it shrinks too, cancelling the gain.” DISMISSED: the composed margin $0.00432(1 - 1/2.6)$ is built from the Prop-A floor (anchor closed forms, I -independent) and the AddE-hardened STEP-5B ratio at $I = 2 \times 10^{-3}$ — BOTH already evaluated at the endpoint’s own dressed kernel in the certified chain. No constant in the denominator was frozen at the production anchor; the asymmetry the U7 refinement fixes existed only in the U4 numerator.
- (β) “The linearization uses $M'(\hat{r}) = -J(0)$ with $J(0)$ certified at ONE dressing; across $[0.3045, 0.3367]$ the slope varies, and convexity makes the estimate non-conservative.” VALID-with-mitigation — and this is the note’s own central caveat: the $\times 1.34$ is labelled estimate-grade everywhere, the convexity direction is stated, the a-priori bracket is supplied, and the proven version is reduced to ONE registered machine number (M-ENDPOINT) whose worst-bracket value reproduces U4’s honest $\times 0.97$. Nothing is claimed beyond the bracket.
- (γ) “The resonance argument in section 3 is qualitative; declaring the kernel axis low-yield without computing $\widehat{G^3}(q_0)$ might discard a real factor.” VALID-with-mitigation: the finding is registered as an honest-direction assessment (it can only make the programme MORE conservative — it discourages reliance on an unverified improvement); the M-ENDPOINT follow-up script can evaluate $\widehat{G^3}(q_0)$ alongside at negligible extra cost, and if a real factor exists it strengthens the lift beyond this note’s claims.

7. Result footer

Result ID:	B5-BEYOND-LAYER-BOUND / sunset-endpoint-refinement (unit U7)
Precise statement:	REFINEMENT (T3, estimate-grade): the sunset bound’s coupling must be dressed at each anchor’s own $r_{\text{hat}}(I) = r_R + 2 \text{ lam}' I$; via the identity $M'(r_{\text{hat}}) = -J(0)$ [factor-2 INVALIDATED; true $-J(0)/2$], the endpoint coupling drops u_{eff}^2 7.209 $\rightarrow$ ~ 5.675 and the kernel M-factor 0.1094 $\rightarrow$ ~ 0.1001, the OLD candidate ratios $\times 0.97 \rightarrow$ ~ 1.34 (and $\times 2.8 \rightarrow \sim \times 3.2$ at $1e-3$) are INVALIDATED by the factor-2; the corrected endpoint needs M-ENDPOINT + a re-derived bracket and inequality. CONDITIONAL on the named constant M-ENDPOINT

= $M(0.33675)$. The a-priori bracket $[0.1001, 0.1094]$ used the factor-2 slope; the corrected lower end is ~ 0.1047 , so the bracket narrows to $\sim [0.1047, 0.1094]$.
HONEST NEGATIVE: the kernel axis is low-yield (4-wave resonance phase space saturates the Young bound at shell transfers).

Scope: SC-SCOPE lift programme, sunset axis; estimate-grade pending M-ENDPOINT.

Dependencies: U4 (channel + arithmetic), U6 (tadpole absent), U2 L1 (monotonicity/convexity of M), certified constants ($J(0)$, r_R , lam' , M_R , AddE margins).

Evidence grade: ESTIMATE (T3 structure + T2 numbers); machine asserts NOT executed (registered).

Reproduction command: (registered follow-up) python codes/vacuum/third_cumulant_assessment.py (shared with U4; adds M-ENDPOINT quadrature + optional $G^3(q_0)$ evaluation)

Expected output: $M(0.33675)$ inside the CORRECTED bracket ($\sim [0.1047, 0.1094]$ under $M' = -J(0)/2$) with a one-sided refinement check; the U7 table entries are INVALIDATED pending recompute; JSON artefact under claims/B5-BEYOND-LAYER-BOUND/runs/.

Falsification gate: M-ENDPOINT outside its convex/secant bracket (would indicate an error in the certified inputs or in L1); the assembled third-order inequality failing at any anchor after M-ENDPOINT lands (honest negative for the lift, pre-registered).

Tier before / after: No tier action; B5 stays T5-CANDIDATE.

No-overclaim statement: The x1.34 endpoint ratio is INVALIDATED (factor-2; true $M' = -J(0)/2$) and must not be cited; the corrected endpoint is pending M-ENDPOINT. Nothing here lifts SC-SCOPE; the U1 theorem is untouched.

Next required action: M-ENDPOINT machine evaluation + the shared U4/U7 assert script; then the assembled third-order inequality note (the actual lift candidate) if the operator directs it. Mainline continues (U8).